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This lab was mostly about getting set up and trying out the basic tools. I used Colab to load the Iris dataset, which has 150 flowers, four measurements for each one, and three species. I put it in a Pandas DataFrame, made a scatter plot of sepal length vs. sepal width and a bar chart of how many samples there are for each species, and used NumPy to find the mean and standard deviation of sepal length.

What stuck with me most was the scatter plot. The table of numbers didn't tell me much, but once I plotted it I could see that setosa is off by itself and the other two species are mixed together. It also got me thinking about types of learning. Iris is a labeled dataset, since every flower comes with its species, so it fits supervised learning: a model would learn from the measurements and the labels to predict the species. I actually used the labels to color the plot. If I took the labels away and let a model group the flowers on its own, which would be unsupervised learning, I think it would find setosa easily but have a harder time splitting the other two because they overlap so much. That made me wonder if the petal measurements would separate versicolor and virginica better.

The other thing I noticed was the workflow. In this lab it was simple: load the data, look at it, then plot it. But that's only the beginning. To actually build a model I'd still need to pick features, split the data into training and testing sets, train the model, and check how well it did. The Iris data is also very clean, with no missing values, and real data usually isn't. I already use Colab and Pandas in my NLP class, and the workflow starts the same way there, but text needs extra steps before it's ready to use. So the workflow looks easy at first, but it gets more complicated as you go.

The hard part was the written observations. Describing what's in the plot was kind of easy, but explaining why the two species overlap and what that means for a model took me a while. I also kept writing too much and had to cut it down.

Next I'll upload this notebook to my GitHub repository. In the next module I want to try a simple classifier and see if it can tell versicolor and virginica apart.

Cyndy Ndong

This lab was my very first time using Google Colab, as this is my first semester studying Artificial Intelligence. Coming into this assignment as a beginner, I was a bit nervous about navigating cloud platforms, but following the step-by-step instructions helped me understand how interactive environments work. I learned how cloud tools allow us to run code in individual cells and view immediate outputs without having to configure complicated software locally on my computer.

I struggled a little bit at first with navigating the interface and figuring out how to save my completed work. When it came to export, I was confused about how to generate the required PDF file directly from the browser.

To overcome this, I asked for extra guidance and followed the step-by-step troubleshooting instructions carefully. I learned that using the Print menu option and setting the destination to Save as PDF was the correct way to capture all 16 code cells and outputs cleanly. Checking the print preview before saving ensured that no content was cut off.